ANX-03 | Therapist guide only

Choosing a response based on need

ANX-03 | A flexible therapist framework, guided by assessment and agreements.

Purpose

Distinguish an addressable practical need from an uncertain prediction and choose a suitable response. One worry may include both. This distinction does not judge whether the client is allowed to worry.

Before use

Choose a worry from the mapping or cycle and clarify relevant facts. Explore urgency, responsibility, resources and others involved without assuming the solution is within the client's control.

A possible working sequence

Open with SES-S01 as needed and close with SES-S02, feedback and a clear plan.

1. State a specific worry and describe what is known and assumed.

2. Check for an actual need, necessary information or professional response to pursue.

3. Distinguish personal influence from others' responsibilities and real limitations.

4. Together choose practical action, suitable inquiry or work on responding to uncertainty; these can be combined.

5. Agree on a step and review time, including what to do if new information appears.

Mindful Path

ANX-03 | Therapist guide only

Examples for exploration, not ready-made tasks

Examples are fictional. A real client's circumstances, needs and wishes take priority.

Group	A conversation example
Children	A child worries about missing equipment tomorrow. Check the requirement and which adult is responsible for helping. Do not give the child responsibilities beyond their control.
Adolescents	A teenager worries a draft is not good enough and does not know its deadline. Clarifying the deadline is practical; it does not ensure certainty about the work's evaluation.
Adults	An adult worries about overlapping commitments. Explore practical coordination alongside worry about never meeting others' expectations.
Older adults	A person is unsure whether an activity's time changed. Relevant information may help without automatically removing every concern about the experience.

A key distinction

Do not delay addressing danger, a health problem or a real need by calling it just worry. Lack of a solution within the client's control does not remove the need; support, rights assistance or another professional may be required.

A question for shared reflection

What requires action or relevant information now, and what uncertainty cannot be solved by another round of checks?

Mindful Path

ANX-03 | Therapist guide only

Individual adaptation and scope

An age label does not replace assessment of development, communication, context and preferences.

Group	A possible approach
Children, approximately ages 6 to 11	Use a concrete situation and one question at a time. The therapist can write spoken answers and check understanding. Hear the child's voice too. Adult roles, sharing and consent depend on the setting and need; do not promise absolute confidentiality.
Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17	Choose a personal focus and recording method that respects privacy. Explore setting, demands and relationships. Explain sharing and consent limits, and arrange help without making practice a test or demand for obedience.
Adults	Include roles, culture, language, circumstances and resources as described. Do not assume time, money or support is available. Shared choice does not replace clinical suitability assessment.
Older adults	Use respectful adult language, comfortable pace and spacing. Ask about preferred completion methods and help without assuming reduced ability or family dependence. Life experience and preferences inform the work.

Checking understanding and choice

Ask the client to explain their understanding and choice in their words. Shorten, leave fields blank or answer aloud. If questions are unsuitable or burdensome, adapt the approach rather than require completion.

This unit's specific boundary

Do not demand perfect information or stop necessary inquiry based on a binary category. Responses may be partial, combined and changing. The form has no threshold deciding how many checks are too many.

Mindful Path

ANX-03 | Therapist guide only

Practice, follow-up and professional review

Practice is chosen jointly; the sheet does not automatically authorize action.

Before practice

Use ANX-03-P to record one choice made in the session and what followed. Practice does not require independent decisions about urgency or avoiding necessary medical assessment. Reassess if circumstances change.

Back in the session

Review actions, opportunities and new information. Core 6 may support a problem-solving step. If approaching an avoided activity is considered, use professional ANX-04 planning only after suitability assessment, not because of the sheet's category.

Production and review status

Original draft guide and sheets. Professional review for each age and a rights review are needed before distribution. Completed writing is not clinical approval; the kit has not been validated or tested for effectiveness.

General sources for further reading

NHS — Tackling your worries
General background on practical problems versus worries about possibilities. These questions were written independently; no external worry tree or form was copied.
https://www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/mental-wellbeing-tips/self-help-cbt-techniques/tackling-your-worries/

NICE CG113 — adults
Professional framework for adult generalized anxiety: assessment, functioning and work by trained therapists. It does not validate these six units or their use with children.
https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/cg113/chapter/Recommendations

Consulted: 03 Nov 2026. Background sources only, without permission to copy forms or validation of the kit.

Reviewer's name, role, date and versions reviewed:

Mindful Path